

Benchmark the Use of Generative AI in HR and the Workforce

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By: David Bobo

Initiatives: Technologies and Markets

Generative AI adoption continues to accelerate within HR and the broader enterprise, with the potential to transform how functions operate and how work gets done. This research will help CHROs benchmark their current GenAI progress and determine whether to pivot their current HR and workforce strategies.

More on This Topic

This is part of an in-depth collection of research. See the collection:

- [Top Insights on AI for CHROs](#)

Overview

Key Findings

- HR teams are accelerating the adoption of in-house generative AI (GenAI) by partnering with IT to design customized AI applications, rather than depending exclusively on prebuilt solutions.
- Organizations are focused on building internal capabilities to navigate the evolving technology landscape, with 35% of HR leaders prioritizing upskilling employees in AI and advanced technologies by January 2025.
- HR leaders are taking a strategic approach to GenAI-driven workforce optimization, with 67% planning to reallocate affected employees and 41% intending to slow hiring.

Recommendations

- Shift from relying on external GenAI technologies to developing internal competencies by strategically identifying key HR functions — such as performance management or learning and development (L&D) — where custom GenAI solutions offer the greatest strategic value and operational efficiency.
- Prepare your workforce for GenAI by assessing current capabilities and increasing investment in AI literacy and upskilling programs.
- Prioritize internal employee reallocation to manage workforce transitions resulting from GenAI-driven efficiencies. Supplement this approach with slower hiring, and consider reductions in force only as a last resort to optimize workforce structure.

Gartner's Take

Organizations need decisive HR leadership to build robust internal capabilities, effectively manage workforce transitions and ensure a human-centric approach to the evolving future of work in response to AI. Without such forward-thinking action, organizations may achieve short-term financial gains but risk undermining their future capacity to navigate AI's transformative impact, ultimately compromising their ability to remain competitive and resilient in a rapidly changing landscape.

Data Insights

GenAI adoption in HR is accelerating, with the percentage of HR leaders in advanced stages of GenAI implementation — either actively planning or already deploying — rising from 19% in June 2023 to 61% by January 2025. Although full-scale implementation has plateaued at 18%, 43% of HR leaders are piloting or planning GenAI initiatives, signaling a robust pipeline for future transformation.

Adoption barriers, rather than market immaturity, hinder progress toward enterprisewide deployment despite the proliferation of pilot programs. To drive large-scale adoption, organizations must address integration challenges, develop compelling business cases and invest in change management. As GenAI adoption stabilizes and the early-adopter window narrows, CHROs face mounting pressure to accelerate strategic initiatives or risk falling behind as GenAI becomes a core driver of competitive advantage.

CHROs should prioritize collaboration with IT and HR technology partners, invest in AI literacy and upskilling, and focus on internal talent redeployment to maximize GenAI-driven efficiencies.

GenAI Piloting Continues to Grow While Implementation Flatlines

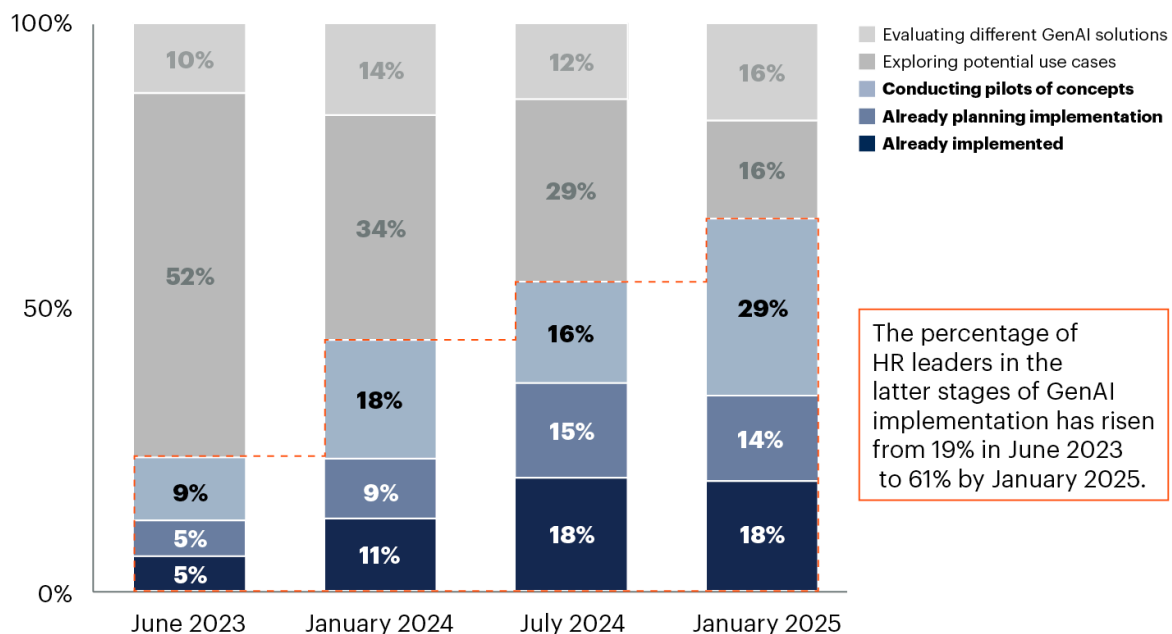
As of January 2025, only 18% of HR leaders report implementing AI in HR. This percentage did not grow between July 2024 and January 2025. However, 43% are piloting or planning implementation, an increase of 12 percentage points over the same time period. Meanwhile, a plateauing trend is emerging in the more advanced stages. The combined percentage of HR leaders actively planning implementation or who have already implemented GenAI remained relatively flat, moving from 33% in July 2024 to 32% by January 2025 (see Figure 1).

The plateau in advanced GenAI adoption, despite more pilots, suggests organizations are struggling to move from experimentation to sustained transformation. CHROs must focus their teams on converting pilot momentum into scalable, value-driven deployments by investing in robust frameworks and cross-functional collaboration.

Figure 1: Majority of HR Leaders Are in the Implementation Phase

Majority of HR Leaders in Implementation Phase

Percentage of HR leaders



n = 92 (January 2025), 73 (July 2024), 179 (January 2024), 105 (June 2023)

Q: How far along are you in planning and preparation for GenAI implementation?

Source: Benchmark With Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs (January 2025), GenAI HR Disruption, Deepfakes at Work and Labor Market Climate (July 2024), The Impact of GenAI on the HR Function and Workforce One Year On (January 2024), Benchmark With Gartner: Special Edition — Navigating the Workforce Impact of Generative AI (June 2023)

Note: Quants corrected the January 2025-2025 number to 61%

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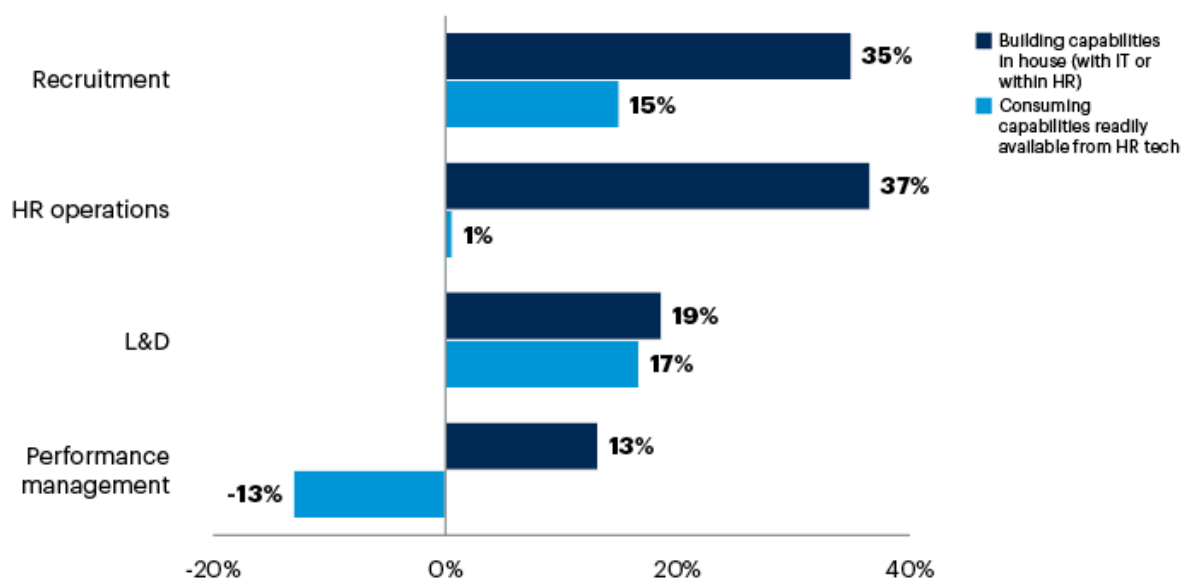
HR Leaders Begin to Shift to Both Consuming and Building Solutions

The landscape of GenAI integration in HR is rapidly evolving, with HR leaders shifting from relying solely on vendor-offered solutions to proactively building and customizing GenAI capabilities in-house, often in partnership with IT. To maximize impact, organizations should use a proven methodology to ideate and prioritize AI use cases in HR (such as [Tool: Develop an HR-Focused AI Strategy](#)), ensuring that pilot projects address the most valuable opportunities. Incorporating lessons from best-practice AI case studies, such as [Case Study: Human-Centric AI Talent Roadmap \(Red Hat\)](#) or [Case Study: Building an AI-Ready Enterprise Workforce](#), can further accelerate successful adoption. This hybrid, evidence-based approach positions HR to drive more tailored and strategic GenAI initiatives across functions such as recruitment, L&D, HR operations and performance management (see Figure 2).

Figure 2: HR Teams Are Rapidly Increasing Their Focus on Building GenAI Capabilities

HR Teams Are Rapidly Increasing Their Focus on Building GenAI Capabilities

Change in percentage of respondents between July 2024 and Jan 2025



n = 65 (Jan 2025), 51 (Jul 2024)

Q: For each of the following HR functions, how have you implemented GenAI capabilities? (Select all that apply); respondents who stated that they had not yet implemented genAI are not included in the denominator of these calculations.

Source: Benchmark with Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs (Jan 2025), GenAI HR Disruption, Deepfakes at Work & Labor Market Climate (Jul 2024)

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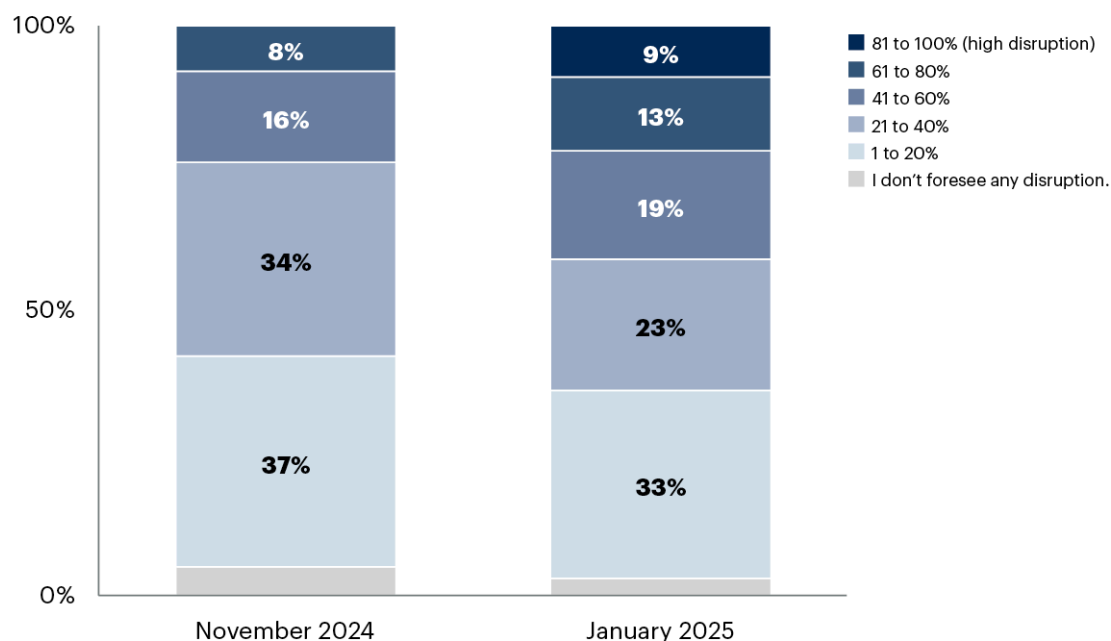
HR Leaders Anticipate Increasing GenAI Impact

The anticipated impact of GenAI on the workforce is increasingly capturing the attention of HR leaders. Survey results from January 2025 reveal a notable shift in expectations, with 9% of HR leaders expecting high levels of workforce disruption. Overall, the percentage of respondents expecting moderate to high disruption (top two boxes) increased from 8% to 22% over that same span. This rapid escalation in perceived disruption suggests that HR leaders, having observed more real-world GenAI applications during this brief period, are beginning to more fully grasp its accelerating potential to transform work processes and roles (see Figure 3).

Figure 3: Increase in Expected GenAI Workforce Disruption

Increase in Expected GenAI Workforce Disruption

Percentage of HR leaders



Q: In the next 2 to 5 years, what percentage of the workforce in your industry is going to be disrupted (change in way of working and/or jobs impacted) through the use of GenAI? (Select one)

Source: Benchmark With Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs (January 2025), Workplace Implications Post U.S. Election and AI Jobs Displacement (November 2024).

Note: Percentages may not add up to 100% because of rounding.

The estimated average workforce disruption was computed using the midpoint of each response option's interval (i.e., 10.5% was used for "Increase by 1 to 20%"). The percentage of leaders selecting each option are weighted in the average.

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GenAI Efficiency Suggests Reallocation of Employees

A key area where organizations expect GenAI to accelerate its impact is on staffing and hiring. In a Gartner survey of organizations between May 2024 and January 2025 to assess anticipated efficiency gains from GenAI, 67% of respondents indicated they would strategically reallocate employees to new roles. Additionally, 49% indicated they would opt not to backfill positions vacated through natural attrition.

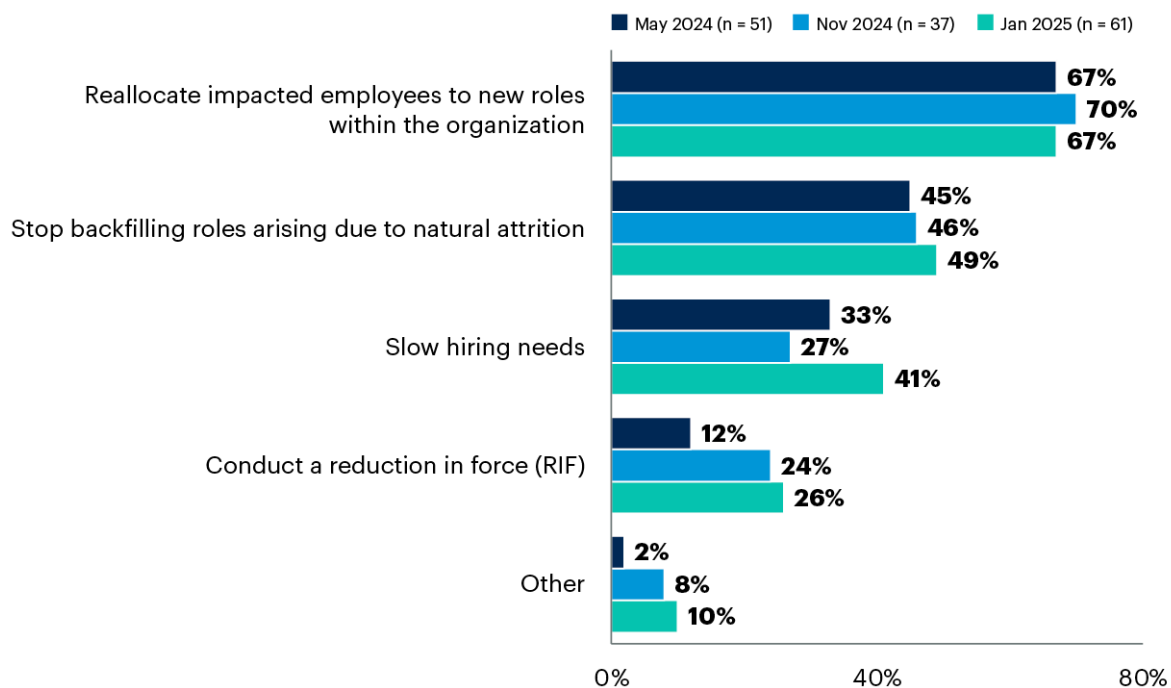
Moreover, if organizations were to realize these GenAI efficiencies, they would begin to strategically slow down hiring. By January 2025, 41% of HR leaders who responded reported they would reduce hiring needs, a significant rise from 27% in November 2024.

Gartner has also observed a notable upward trend in reductions in force (RIFs). When respondents were surveyed in May 2024 about how they anticipated realizing efficiency gains from GenAI through workforce reductions, only 12% identified RIFs as their preferred approach. By January 2025, this figure had risen to 26%. Although RIFs remain among the less favored options, this increase indicates a gradual but consistent upward trend over the last year (see Figure 4).

Figure 4: GenAI Reallocation of Employees

Most Orgs Would Continue to Use GenAI Gains to Reallocate Employees

Percentage of HR leaders



n = varies

Q: If your organization was able to achieve cost and productivity gains as a result of GenAI, how would your organization use these gains? (Select all that apply)

Source: Benchmark with Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs (Jan 2025), Workplace Implications Post U.S. Election and AI Jobs Displacement (Nov 2024), AI Jobs Displacement, Workforce Social Media Activism and the Labor Market Climate (May 2024)

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Gartner

HR Prioritizing AI Upskilling

HR leaders are increasingly prioritizing upskilling initiatives to help employees adapt to AI and GenAI technologies. In January 2025, 35% of HR leaders reported updating development plans to strengthen employees' abilities to use AI and related advanced technologies in their work, a notable increase from 20% in May 2024. This trend demonstrates a growing commitment within HR to proactively equip the workforce with the necessary skills to navigate and leverage emerging technologies.

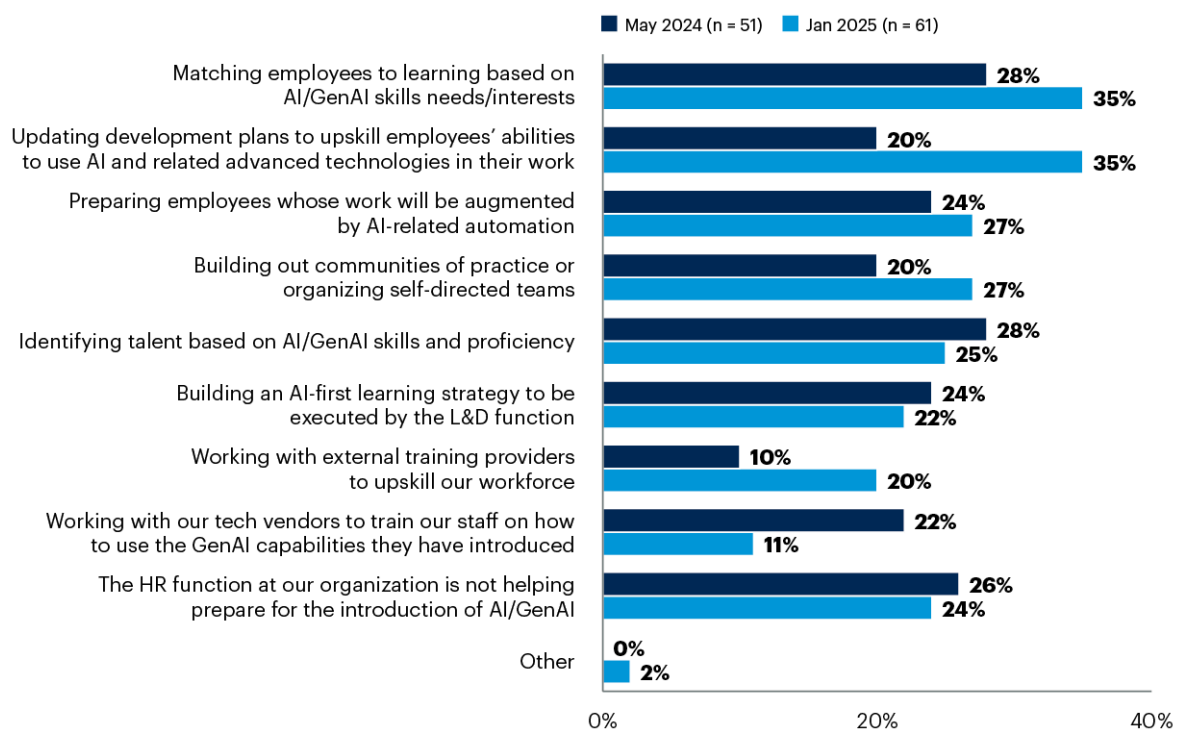
Beyond updating development plans, HR leaders are placing greater emphasis on aligning learning opportunities with both organizational needs and employee interests. In January 2025, 35% of HR leaders identified assessing and matching employees to learning based on AI and GenAI skills needs and interests as a top priority, up from 25% in November 2024. This shift highlights a more targeted approach, ensuring that upskilling efforts are strategically focused and relevant to both the business and its employees.

While upskilling remains a central focus, HR leaders' perspectives on automation are also evolving. The proportion of HR leaders anticipating that AI-related automation will augment roles decreased to 27% in January 2025 from 34% in November 2024, though this is still above the 24% reported in May 2024. Even if expectations around automation-driven role augmentation have moderated, this continues to be a relevant consideration for HR strategy (see Figure 5).

Figure 5: How HR Is Helping the Organization

What HR Is Doing to Help the Organization With the Introduction of AI/GenAI

Percentage of HR leaders



n = varies

Q: How is the HR function at your organization helping prepare for the introduction of AI/GenAI? (select all that apply)

Source: Benchmark with Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs (Jan 2025), AI Jobs Displacement, Workforce Social Media Activism and the Labor Market Climate (May 2024)

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As the landscape of GenAI continues to evolve, organizations are adopting strategic measures to ensure their workforce is well-prepared and capable of thriving in this new era, as evidenced by the following trends:

- Prioritizing workforce preparation for AI advancements through internal upskilling and assessment of AI-related skills.
- Identifying key roles poised for short- to medium-term productivity gains from GenAI, and developing a medium- to long-term AI literacy roadmap to upskill the broader workforce.
- Collaborating with business leaders to strategically assess and address the long-term impact of AI on jobs and roles, including shifting toward more structured approaches to AI integration beyond self-directed teams.

By enhancing AI literacy and strategically reallocating talent, organizations can effectively leverage GenAI efficiencies and mitigate workforce disruption.

Evidence

2024 Gartner AI Mandates for the Enterprise Survey: This study was conducted to understand how AI and generative AI (GenAI) are being adopted by enterprises, focusing on areas such as AI strategy, data, governance, literacy, engineering, organization, portfolio and value, to assist clients in keeping pace with AI's rapid evolution. The research was conducted online from October through December 2024 among 432 respondents from the U.S. (n = 181), the U.K. (n = 70), France (n = 50), Germany (n = 50), India (n = 51) and Japan (n = 30). Quotas were established for company sizes and for industries to ensure a good representation across the sample. Organizations were required to have deployed at least one AI use case in production. Respondents were screened for C-level executives (e.g., chief AI officer, chief data officer, chief data scientist, chief digital officer, chief information officer, chief operating officer, chief technology officer or equivalent) or roles above vice presidents. All respondents were required to have high involvement in at least one AI initiative. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

2025 Benchmark With Gartner: GenAI Workforce Disruption and New-Collar Jobs

Webinar Polling: This live polling webinar was conducted to enable HR leaders to discuss stands their peers are taking on timely critical concerns that impact key talent decisions HR leaders need to make. The main topics covered in this webinar include the labor market climate outlook update for talent-based leading indicators of economic conditions, GenAI workforce disruptions, the emergence of new-collar jobs and U.S. presidential executive order implications. The webinar was conducted on 27 January 2025 with responses from over 40 HR leaders participating across a spectrum of industries, with a focus on North America. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Methodology Statement: P-24061 2024 Gartner AI Mandates for the Enterprise Survey

2024 Gartner AI Mandates for the Enterprise Survey. This study was conducted to understand how AI and generative AI (GenAI) are being adopted by enterprises, focusing on areas such as AI strategy, data, governance, literacy, engineering, organization, portfolio and value, to assist clients in keeping pace with AI's rapid evolution. The research was conducted online from October through December 2024 among 432 respondents from the U.S. (n = 181), the U.K. (n = 70), France (n = 50), Germany (n = 50), India (n = 51) and Japan (n = 30). Quotas were established for company sizes and for industries to ensure a good representation across the sample. Organizations were required to have deployed at least one AI use case in production. Respondents were screened for C-level executives (e.g., chief AI officer, chief data officer, chief data scientist, chief digital officer, chief information officer, chief operating officer, chief technology officer or equivalent) or roles above vice presidents. All respondents were required to have high involvement in at least one AI initiative. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Recommended by the Author

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

[Top Insights on AI for CHROs](#)

[How CHROs Can Prepare Their Function and the Enterprise for AI Transformation](#)

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